

TWO-WAY FINESSE

South opens a 5+-card major (1♥ or 1♠), the partnership reaches a major game or 3NT, and South declares.

Teaching feature: declarer's diamond suit is AJx in South opposite KTx in North — missing only the Queen. The finesse can be taken EITHER way:

- Lead low from dummy toward South's AJ, finesse the J. Wins if East has the Q.
- Lead low from South toward dummy's KT, finesse the T. Wins if West has the Q.

The challenge is deciding which way to commit.

Things to think about:

- Did the auction give either defender a chance to show shape or strength?
- What did the opening lead suggest about distribution?
- Watch early tricks for count signals or revealed lengths.
- Vacant places: if one defender has shown more of the other suits, the Q is more likely with the other defender.
- With no information at all, it's 50/50 — pick a side and commit.

Reference: https://www.bridgebum.com/two_way_finesse.php